

tive of Burger Singh is its proven franchise model, which helps us expand rapidly,” says Co-founder & CEO Kabir Jeet Singh.

Dhawan also owns a 0.49% stake in Slurrp Farm, an internet-first brand offering millet-based foods for kids and toddlers. Sadhan, a tech-enabled logistics service provider, is also in his start-up portfolio. With a stake of 9.4%, his ₹10-crore investment in Sadhan was worth nearly ₹75 crore, Tracxn data shows. Likewise, the name of Sunil Singhania, Founder of Abakkus Asset Manager LLP, also appeared among investors in Bengaluru-based fintech start-up BankSathi, which raised \$4 million in a new round from a couple of investors in January 2023. Singhania declined to speak about the start-up space and his investments.

42 | Independent market analyst Ambareesh Baliga, who has nearly four decades of market experience and has worked with financial firms such as Karvy and Edelweiss, says he has invested in start-ups such as Basic Home Loans, an online platform for home loans; Nova Nova, which offers healthy snacks; and AdOnMo, which offers digital screen-based ad solutions. “Tyke, Castler, Celcius, Let’s Try, Zypp Electric, Autocracy, ALYF (ShareNest), BluSmart and Ease My Trade (StockDaddy) are among other start-ups where I am invested,” he says.

Baliga invests in start-ups at an early stage, which is completely contrary to his investment process in the secondary market. “My investment decisions at this stage are driven purely by a few key metrics—the founders, their background, clarity of what they want the start-up to be and how they can take it there. The product today and the potential for it to change/pivot based on market factors and scalability in the next two to three years. It’s important for



“We have a proven franchise model that helps in rapid expansion... It is attractive to investors for its ability to quickly multiply outlets and increase revenue potential”

KABIR JEET SINGH
CO-FOUNDER & CEO,
BURGER SINGH
BURGER SINGH IS AN INVESTEE
COMPANY OF ASHISH DHAWAN



“[Vijay Kedia’s investment in TAC Infosec] not only validates our mission and strategies but also instils a deep sense of trust and credibility among other potential investors and partners”

TRISHNEET ARORA
FOUNDER & CEO,
TAC INFOSEC
TAC IS AN INVESTEE COMPANY OF
VIJAY KEDIA

the founders to be passionate about the business; however, just being passionate without a clear scheme to implement the goals can be disastrous,” he says.

Why are big investors hunting for start-ups when there are thousands of listed firms? It’s not just about the returns, says Rishiraj Maheshwari, Founder and CEO of RISCH Wealth & RISCH Family Office. “Ace investors from equity markets often have significant experience in both entrepreneurship and investing,” says Maheshwari. “Many have built successful businesses themselves and have a keen eye for promising start-ups. Their experience allows them to assess the potential of early-stage companies, identify risks, and provide valuable mentorship to the founders they invest in. Additionally, their networks and connections can be invaluable resources for the start-ups they support.”

RISKS INVOLVED

What about the risks in betting on a start-up that could flop? Safir Anand says promoter mindset is the first risk. “Many promoters are initially focussed on work and business, but as they raise rounds of money, hubris sets in. They start daydreaming about the valuations surging and themselves as the next millionaires or billionaires and focussing less on the business.”

Anand says there are conflicts of interest between venture capitalists (VCs) and businesses. A VC usually wants to exit within a fixed period and is guided by IRR or the internal rate of return. “The VC sometimes pushes businesses to grow even if growth is a negative to cash flows and laden with risks.”

Prateek Jain, Associate Director-Start-up and Alliances, Alliance of Digital India Foundation (ADIF),